

June 16, 2023.

As part of the ARC II project, the Agency, in cooperation with the Croatian Chamber of Economy and the University of North, held another consultation on the protection of personal data for micro, small, and medium-sized enterprises titled “5 Years of GDPR Implementation: Problems, Solutions, Penalties, and Examples of Good Practice” at the University of North in Varaždin.

“Investing in data protection is certainly not a cost; it will pay off. It is better to invest in information security than to pay fines,” emphasized Director Zdravko Vukić. “It is high time that all data controllers/processors understand that the deadline for adjustment has passed and that after five years from the start of the full implementation of the General Data Protection Regulation, ignorance and lack of knowledge can no longer serve as justification or excuse for violating the fundamental rights of Croatian citizens. Therefore, by organizing such educational events, we help data controllers/processors address all the uncertainties they encounter when aligning with the General Data Protection Regulation,” said Vukić.

“There is never enough education, and consultations are never sufficient. First and foremost, we need to prevent and raise awareness, as data processing brings certain risks on a daily basis,” emphasized the advisor to the president of the Croatian Chamber of Economy and Vice-Rector of the University of North, Associate Professor Dr. Petar Mišević, highlighting that investing in personal data protection should not be perceived as a cost. “Investing in personal data protection is an investment that guarantees survival in the market, especially for the private sector, but also for all other organizations, in today’s digital environment. Protecting information assets and safeguarding citizens’ privacy is a significant and responsible task for all of us,” stated Petar Mišević.

Participants in the consultation had the opportunity to familiarize themselves with examples of good practice in the field of personal data protection, share with the Agency’s experts the problems they encounter in the application of the General Data Protection Regulation, and, with the support of experts, find solutions that will elevate the level of compliance in their organizations to a higher level. Additionally, Agency officials spoke about aligning business processes with GDPR, specifically where organizations most often make mistakes; technical and organizational measures for data protection; how to prepare for the Agency’s supervisory and investigative activities; and penalties for violators of GDPR and the Act on the Implementation of the General Data Protection Regulation.

In its advisory role, the Agency continuously organizes various educational activities aimed at all target groups, primarily data controllers/processors and data protection officers. However, the educational and supervisory activities conducted show that the level of compliance with the legislative framework for data protection in the Republic of Croatia is still not at a satisfactory level. Therefore, the Agency will continue its educational activities aimed at all target groups, especially data controllers/processors and data protection officers, and the schedule of workshops can be viewed [here](#).